

County Administration Workshop: September 15, 2026

1:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman,
Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The Board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Information Technology

1. Strategic Communication Planning

Thomas Gray, Public Information and Web Coordinator, reported that the second review period for the Strategic Communications Plan had concluded without additional edits and that the plan was ready for final review. He planned to consult Legal Counsel regarding whether formal adoption or Board consensus would be the appropriate approval process. Gray also reported that updates to the County social media and public records policies were nearing completion. CivicsPlus social-media archiving was being rolled out to improve public-record retention and moderation compliance, and Loomly social-media planning software was being expanded to additional departments following an initial rollout with Public Health. Gray said the County currently maintains approximately 24 to 25 social-media accounts across several departments and platforms, with content oversight shared between his office and the responsible department leadership.

Gray also discussed communications work with Emergency Management, including Firewise materials, Know Your Zone and emergency-notification planning, and development of the jocoalerts.org web address as a centralized location for emergency information. He reported that Economic Development Grant promotions were underway and that the AI pilot project remained on schedule for an end-of-week report, including policy recommendations and a proposed auditing/logging tool for County AI software. Website accessibility work was expected to begin in October toward the federal compliance deadline in late April 2027. Gray also reported positive feedback on the weekly County updates and said onboarding had begun for JustFOIA, which will provide a centralized public-record-request portal and tracking system; he currently receives approximately five to ten requests per week. No formal action was taken.

b. Prevention

1. Grant Agreement with Continuum Behavioral Health & Recovery Services for Opioid Settlement Funds Abatement Strategies - \$140,206.58

Shawn Martinez, Prevention and Treatment Services Manager, reviewed the County's opioid-settlement funding program before presenting the applications. She explained that Josephine County has 13 opioid settlements with varying payment schedules and reporting requirements, and that required reporting is current. The County has approximately \$4.7 million in settlement funds on hand or projected over the life of the settlements. Prior community planning identified allowable priorities under Exhibit E, including overdose reversal, medication-assisted treatment, services for pregnant and postpartum women, warm handoffs and recovery services, treatment for incarcerated populations, prevention, syringe-service programs, and evidence-based data collection. The current application round opened May 15 and closed June 15; a subcommittee reviewed three applications and the Addictions Mental Health Public Health Advisory Committee recommended all three to the Board. Martinez then presented Continuum Behavioral Health & Recovery Services' request for \$140,206.58 to support naloxone, medication-assisted treatment, services for pregnant and postpartum women, and expanded warm-handoff services. The proposal includes ambulatory withdrawal management in Cave Junction and Grants Pass and inpatient withdrawal

management at Mountain View Recovery Center, with funding for psychiatric nursing and addiction-medicine physician services. Martinez said the program is intended to become self-sustaining through billable services once established and would add local detoxification capacity.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Grant Agreement with Continuum Behavioral Health & Recovery Services for Opioid Settlement Funds Abatement Strategies in the amount of \$140,206.58. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Grant Agreement of Opioid Settlement Funding with Grants Pass Sobering Center - \$44,239.68

Martinez presented the Grants Pass Sobering Center request for \$44,239.68 to expand warm-handoff and recovery services. The funding would support peer services so that assistance remains available 24 hours a day, 365 days a year. Martinez explained that a warm handoff connects a person who is willing to enter treatment directly with peer support and treatment providers rather than simply providing a referral. The Board discussed the growth of the Sobering Center from its original function into a broader recovery-support resource and the importance of maintaining sufficient staffing for around-the-clock services.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Grant Agreement of Opioid Settlement Funding with Grants Pass Sobering Center in the amount of \$44,239.68. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. Grant Agreement for Opioid Settlement Funding with HIV Alliance - \$28,874.00

Martinez presented HIV Alliance's request for \$28,874.00 to support naloxone access and overdose-reversal training, medication-assisted treatment connections, infectious-disease testing, and linkage to care for high-risk individuals affected by substance-use disorder. The proposal integrates HIV, hepatitis C and syphilis rapid testing with care coordination and peer-support services. Martinez clarified that none of the requested settlement funds would be used to purchase syringes. The Board discussed harm-reduction services, prior funding history, and the fact that HIV Alliance is headquartered in Eugene but provides services in Southern Oregon, including Josephine County. Following approval of all three grants, Martinez and the Board discussed the finite nature of the settlement funds, whether long-term investment or endowment-type use is permissible, and the importance of supporting programs that can become sustainable. Martinez stated she would verify the applicable restrictions and noted a continuing community need for residential treatment capacity.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Grant Agreement for Opioid Settlement Funding with HIV Alliance in the amount of \$28,874.00. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Human Resources

1. Position Requisitions

- a) Public Health - Family Services Program Dietitian - Add Position
- b) Public Health - Program Specialist Solid Waste - Add Position
- c) Community Justice - Juvenile Justice - Refill Vacated Position and Change Current Job Description - Vacated 08/10/2026
- d) Clerk - Election Help - Add 20 Temp Positions

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented the four position requisitions. The Public Health Family Services Program Dietitian and Program Specialist - Solid Waste positions were added through the supplemental-budget process and their job descriptions were ready for recruitment. The Juvenile Justice vacancy, created August 10, 2026, had an updated job description intended to clarify duties and provide additional coverage within Juvenile Justice. The Clerk requested authority to add 20 temporary

election-help positions for the upcoming election. Eckhardt-Doupe stated the requisitions and supporting job descriptions would be routed to the Board for signatures. The Board also noted that the dietitian position is grant/state funded and discussed use of Solid Waste-related revenue and grant funding for the Solid Waste position.

2. Personnel Actions

a) Sheriff - Patrol Deputy - New Hire

Eckhardt-Doupe presented a Sheriff's Office personnel action for a certified lateral Patrol Deputy candidate currently completing the hiring and credentialing process. She stated the candidate is coming from Curry County and, if all requirements are satisfied, would be able to enter the position with prior law-enforcement training and experience. The personnel action would authorize the new hire upon successful completion of the required process and would be routed for Board signatures.

3. Board Business

a. Stonefly Subdivision Plat Map Approval

The Board reviewed the Stonefly Subdivision plat map. Commissioners indicated they had reviewed the plat and noted the additional housing the subdivision would provide in the local area.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the Stonefly Subdivision plat map. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Appointments to the Josephine County Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee

Tabled.

c. Federal Roadless Rule comment

Commissioner Richardson presented Josephine County's proposed comment regarding the U.S. Forest Service rulemaking on the 2001 Roadless Area Conservation Rule. He stated that approximately 146,000 acres in Josephine County carry a roadless designation and that the County's principal request was to have a meaningful role in future rulemaking affecting local federal lands. The Board discussed the importance of considering Josephine County-specific conditions, including wildfire suppression and mitigation, emergency evacuation routes, road maintenance, and protection of water resources. Input had been incorporated from Emergency Management, Public Works, and the Sheriff's Office. Commissioners emphasized that wilderness areas are governed separately and that the County comment was intended to ensure local conditions and public-safety needs are considered rather than relying only on national-level assumptions.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve submission of Josephine County's comment to the US Forest Service regarding the proposed rescission of the 2001 Roadless Area Conservation Rule. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

4. OTHER

Commissioner Martin added that federal analysis should account for local conditions and local cost impacts, including wildfire mitigation and road-maintenance needs. The Board briefly discussed wildfire containment planning and the potential interaction between roadless-area rules and federal wildfire-mitigation strategies. No additional action was taken.

5. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

Commissioners Richardson and Martin had no announcements. Chair Smith reminded the public that fire season remained in effect and urged continued caution.

The meeting adjourned at 2:27 p.m.